Commemorative Speech: My Father

Clean version (to practice and memorize)

Good [morning/afternoon], everyone.

When I was a little girl, I used to ask my dad about his childhood. And every time he answered, I felt something heavy in my chest. Today, I want to honor that man: my father, [his name].

My dad is a humble man. He doesn't talk about himself much, and he never asks for credit. But behind his quiet smile, there is a story that most people will never know.

My father lost his dad when he was very young. And his mother was not there for him. So while other children were playing, going to school, and being taken care of, my dad was working. He started working when he was just a child. Not because he wanted to, but because he had to.

Think about that for a second. A boy with no father to guide him and no mother to hold him, learning how to survive on his own.

When I was little and he told me these stories, I didn't fully understand them. I just knew they made me sad. I remember wishing I could go back in time and give that little boy a hug.

But here is what amazes me. Life gave my father every reason to be bitter. Instead, he chose to be kind. Nobody ever showed him how to be a parent, and yet he became the father I always needed. He showed up. He worked hard. And he made sure we never had to feel what he felt.

Everything I am today, I learned from watching him. He taught me that hard work is not something to complain about. It is a way of taking care of the people you love. He taught me to respect every dollar, because he knows how hard each one is to earn. And he taught me that where you start does not decide where you finish.

So, Dad, thank you. Thank you for breaking the cycle. Thank you for giving me the childhood you never had. You may be a humble man, but to me, you are the strongest person I know.

Thank you.

Marked version (with pauses and expressions)

Legend: / = short pause (1 sec) | // = long pause (2 sec) | **WORD** = stress this word | *(cue)* = expression or gesture

(Smile, look into the camera) Good [morning/afternoon], everyone. /

(Calm, a little nostalgic) When I was a **little** girl, I used to ask my dad about his childhood. / And every time he answered, / I felt something **heavy** in my chest. *(Hand on your chest)* //

Today, I want to honor that man: / my father, [his name]. //

(Warm tone) My dad is a **humble** man. He doesn't talk about himself much, / and he **never** asks for credit. / But behind his quiet smile, / there is a story that most people will **never** know. //

(Slow down, softer voice) My father lost his dad when he was **very** young. // And his mother / was not there for him. //

So while other children were **playing**, / going to **school**, / and being **taken care of**, *(count with your fingers: 1, 2, 3)* / my dad was **working**. / He started working when he was just a **child**. / Not because he **wanted** to, / but because he **had** to. //

(Look straight into the camera, serious) Think about that for a second. // A boy with **no** father to guide him / and **no** mother to hold him, / learning how to survive **on his own**. //

(Softer, emotional) When I was little and he told me these stories, / I didn't fully understand them. / I just knew they made me **sad**. / I remember wishing I could go back in time / and give that little boy **a hug**. //

(Lift your energy, stronger voice) But here is what **amazes** me. // Life gave my father **every** reason to be bitter. / Instead, / he chose to be **kind**. / Nobody ever showed him how to be a parent, / and **yet** he became the father I always **needed**. / He showed **up**. / He worked **hard**. / And he made sure we **never** had to feel what he felt. //

(Proud tone, open hand toward the camera) Everything I am today, / I learned from watching **him**. / He taught me that hard work is **not** something to complain about. / It is a way of **taking care** of the people you love. / He taught me to respect **every** dollar, / because he knows how **hard** each one is to earn. / And he taught me / that where you **start** / does not decide where you **finish**. //

(Slow, soft, as if talking to him) So, Dad, / thank you. / Thank you for **breaking** the cycle. / Thank you for giving me the childhood **you** never had. // You may be a humble man, / but to me, / you are the **strongest** person I know. //

(Smile, hold eye contact 2 seconds) Thank you.

Guía rápida (en español)

- **Duración:** unas 350 palabras, que con las pausas dan entre 2:40 y 3:00. **Cronométrate.** Si pasas de 3:00, quita primero "Think about that for a second." y después "He showed up. He worked hard."
- **No lo leas palabra por palabra.** La tarea lo exige en mayúsculas. Practica la versión limpia 5 veces en voz alta, y la última vez usa solo la versión marcada para las pausas.
- **Si necesitas apoyo**, pega debajo de la cámara solo estas palabras clave: *heavy chest → humble → lost his dad / mother → working as a child → no father, no mother → little boy hug → chose to be kind → every dollar → start/finish → Dad, thank you*.
- **Si te emocionas, está bien.** Respira, haz la pausa y sigue. En un discurso conmemorativo eso suma.

- **Grabación:** de una sola vez y sin editar. Celular horizontal, a la altura de los ojos. Mira el lente. En YouTube ponlo en **Unlisted**, nunca en Private.

Peer Review Template (3 classmates)

> Hi [name], [one specific thing they did well, e.g., “your pause before talking about your grandmother was powerful” / “you kept great eye contact with the camera”]. One thing you could work on is [one specific, kind suggestion, e.g., “slowing down a little so each example has time to land” / “using your hands more” / “looking up from your notes more often”]. Overall, your tribute to [person/place] really showed [what you felt].